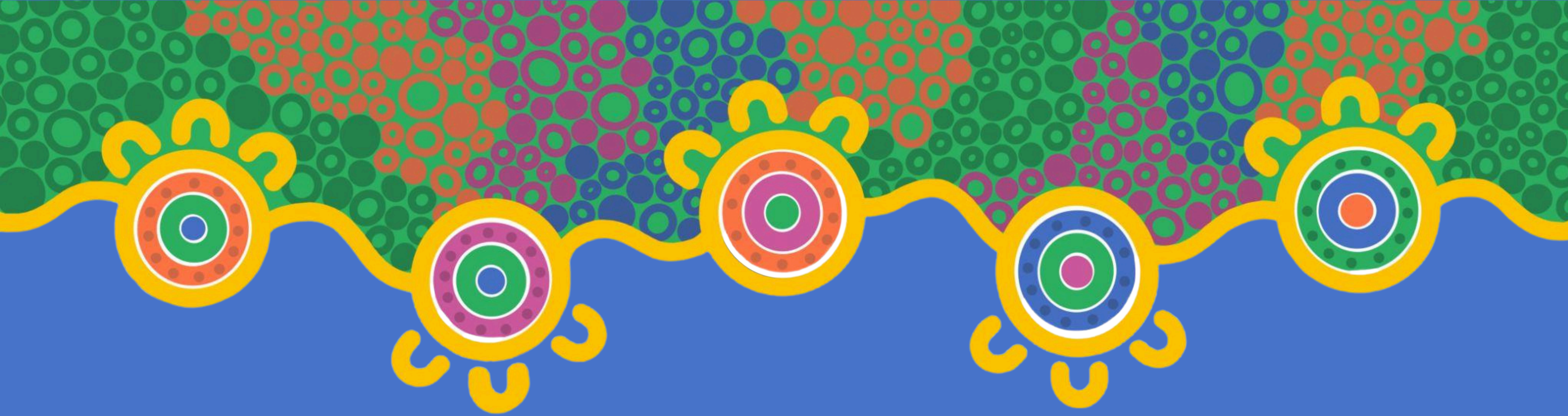


COMP3110

Building for impact

Developing, sharpening, and pitching ideas that matter:
Lessons from a career in media, international
development, and AI Education





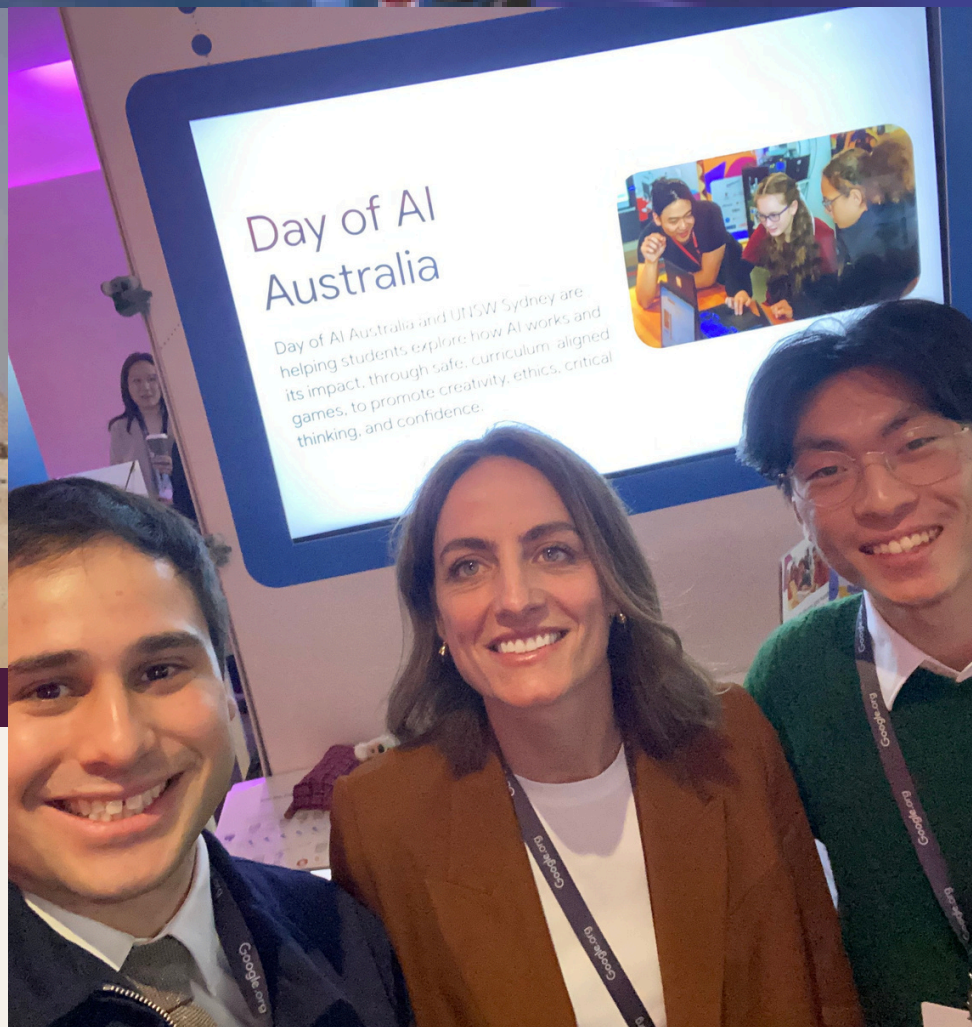
I acknowledge Bidjigal and Gadigal people of the Eora Nation as the Traditional Custodians and first scientists, innovators, and educators of this land and their continuing connection to Country.

I pay our respects to the Elders past and present.



Today

1. **What is social impact**
 2. **Tools and techniques to help shape your idea**
 3. **Running your project**
 4. **Sharing your proposal (and thinking about your stakeholders)**
 5. **Finding a social impact problem**
 6. **Resources**
- 
- 



Tash Banks

Program Director, Day of AI Australia

- **BA and M Int. Dev.**
- **More than a decade experience in media**
- **Now leading an education charity**
- **Values and mission driven work**

a focus on social impact, I just didn't always call it that



Social Impact

Positive, measurable change in communities

Education

Economic development

Environmental sustainability

Health and basic needs

....and more





The trap

Too often people arrive with solutions.





Design Thinking

Solving problems by starting with real people, not assumptions, technology, or existing solutions.

Human Centred Design

Designing with the people who'll actually use it, not for who you assume they are.

Human Rights Based Approach

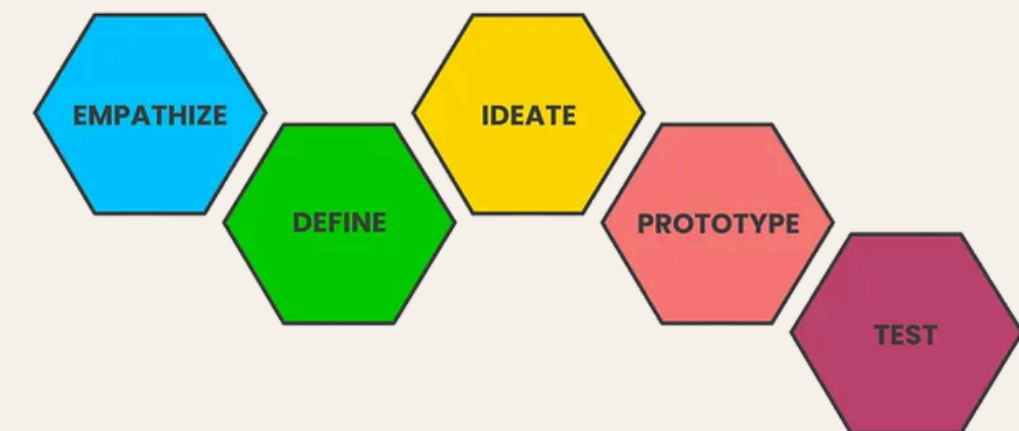
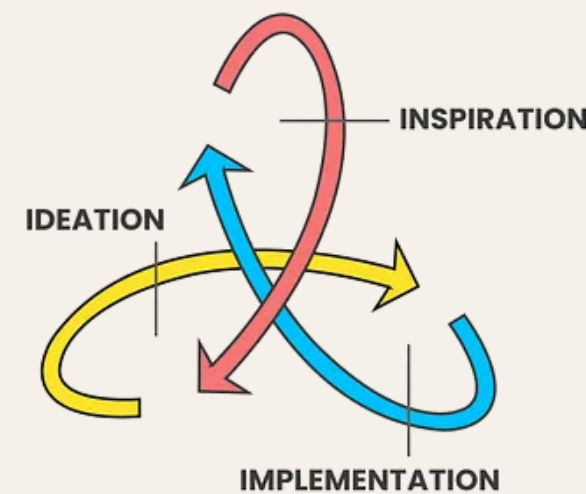
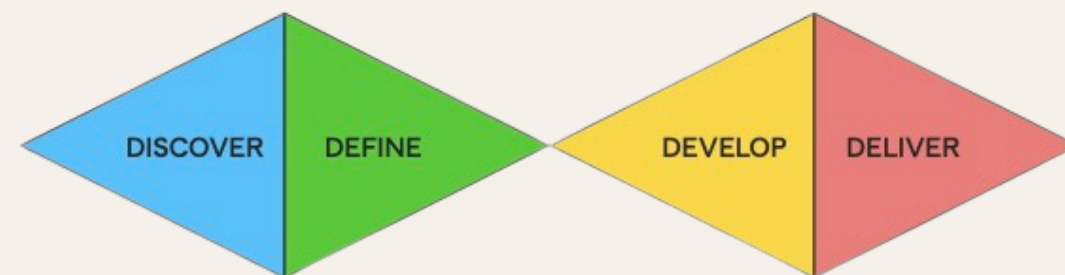
People hold rights by default, not needs met at someone else's discretion.



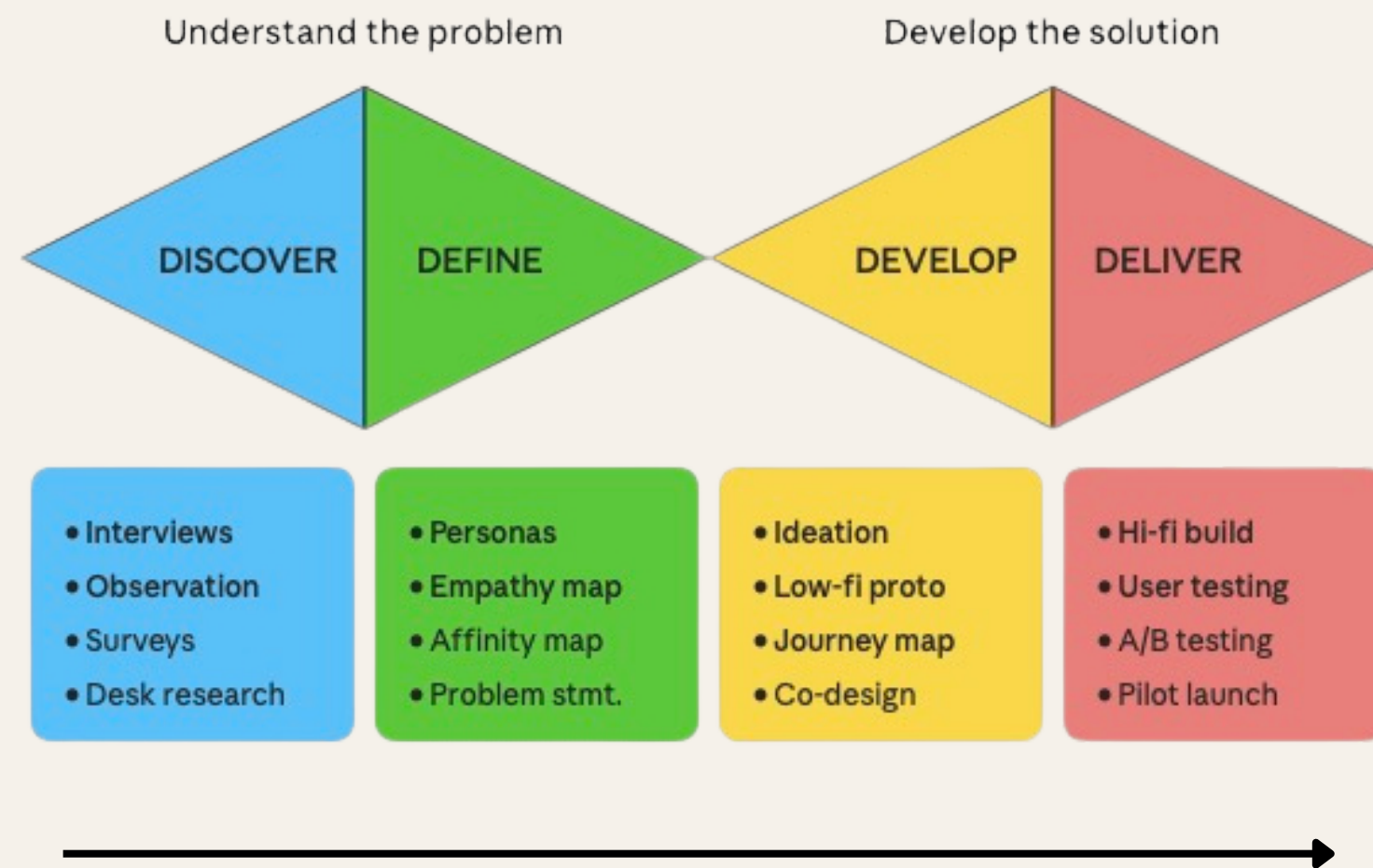
Design Thinking

Helps you think like a designer

- Design Council's double diamond. Stanford's d.school. IDEO's 3 I model. Google design sprint. IBM's design loop.
- General principles: human-centred, bias towards action, show don't tell, craft clarity, radical collaboration, culture of prototyping and experimentation, mindful of process
- They all say the same thing: talk to real people before you build anything!



Design Thinking



Discover:

- Explore the problem space
- Diverse insights
- User research

Define:

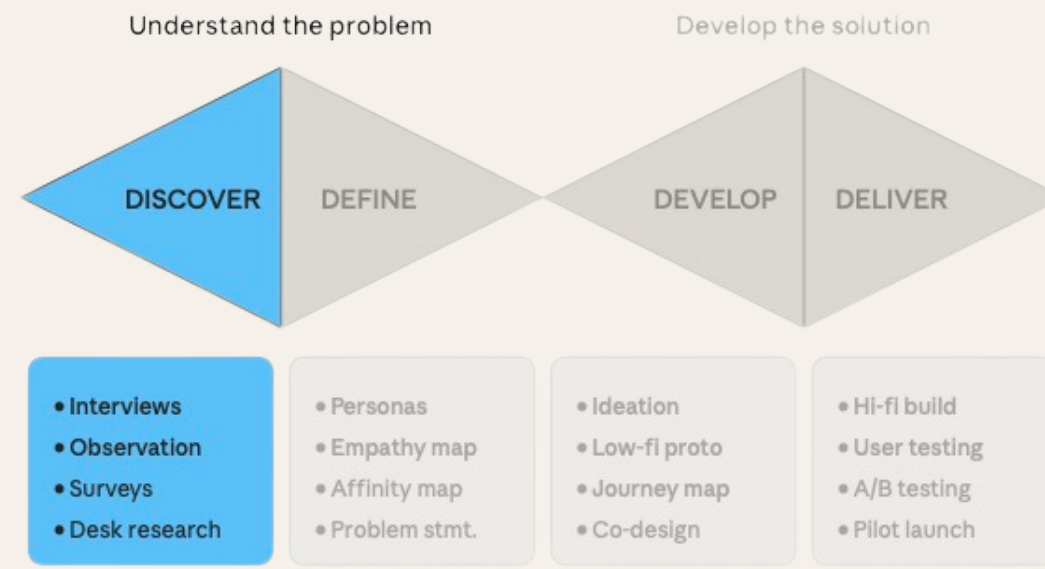
- Problem statement
- Set a direction for ideation

Develop:

- Generate a wide range of creative solutions
- Iterative refinement based on feedback

Deliver:

- Finalise the solution
- Evaluation for continuous improvement



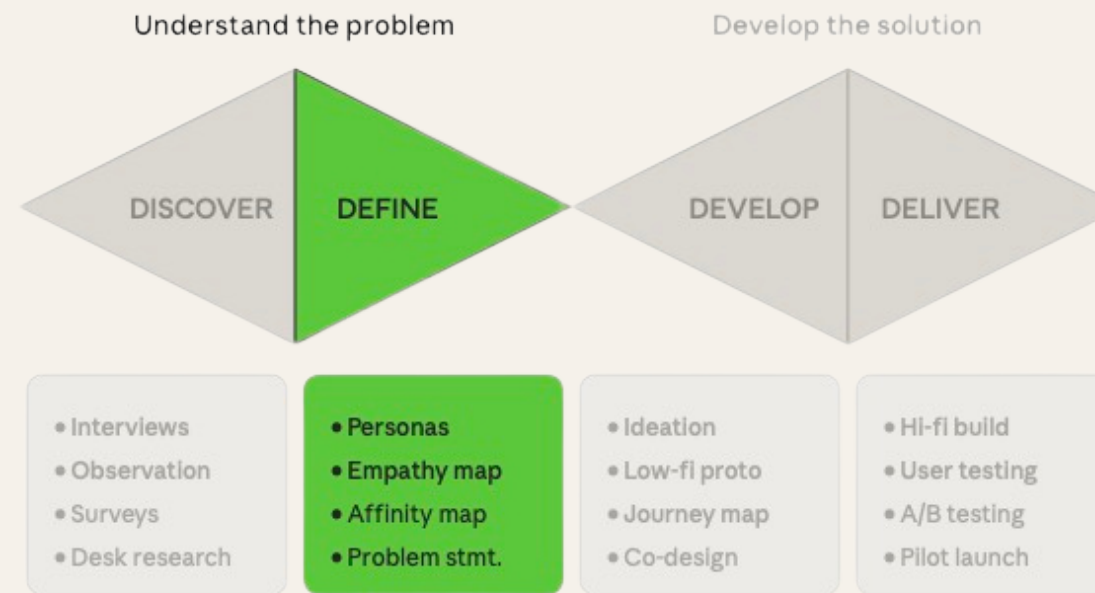
INTERVIEWS

- Semi-structured interviews
- To help understand goals, use cases, sentiments, experience, meaning, and more
- Can record the conversation only with interviewees' consent. Take detailed notes!

OBSERVATION (CONTEXTUAL ENQUIRY)

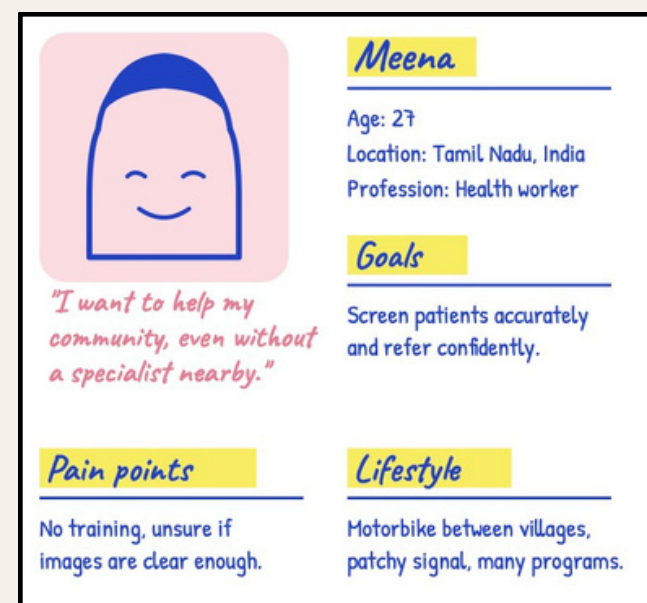
- Watching what people actually do, not just what they say they do





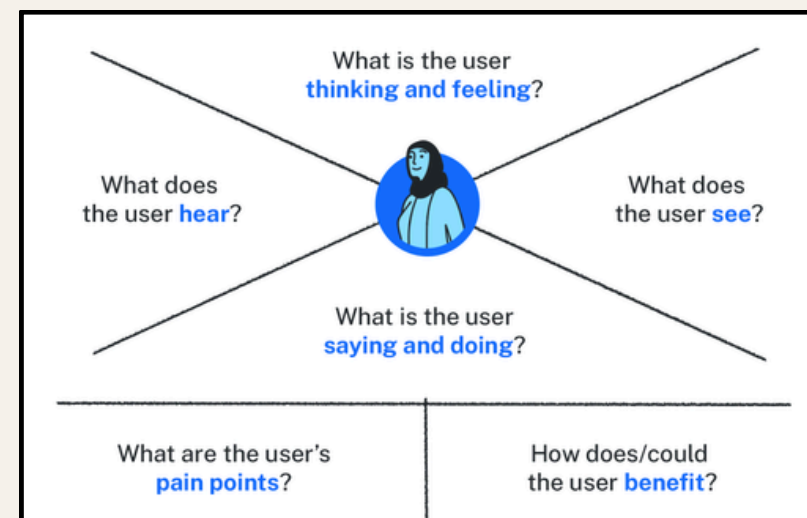
USER PERSONAS

- Condenses insights into fictional but data-backed profiles representing your core user segments



EMPATHY MAPPING

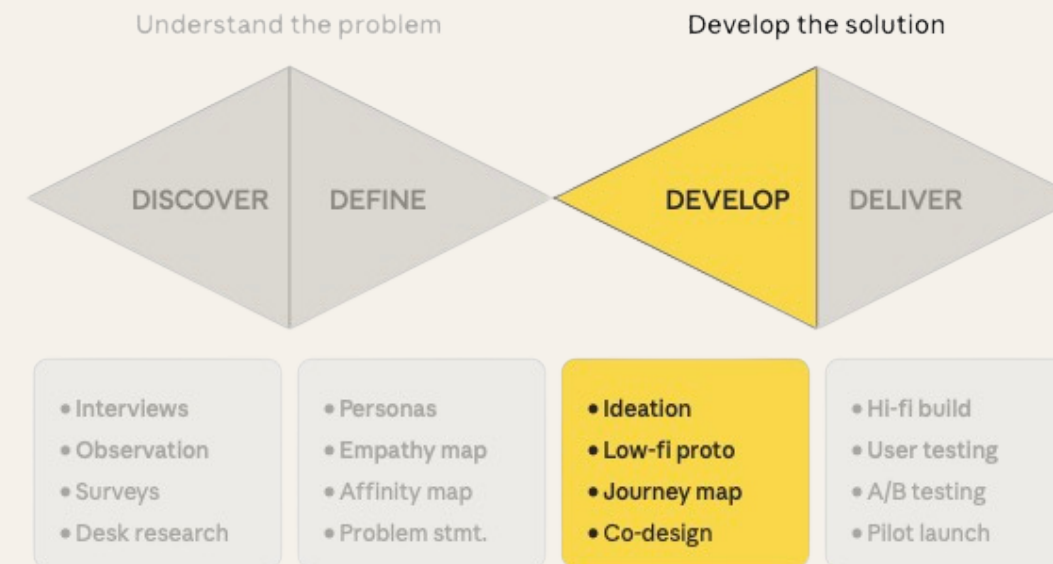
- Organise insights by what users Say, Think, Do, and Feel
- Grounds your data in human emotion
- Can reveal contradictions (Say one thing but Do another)



PROBLEM STATEMENT

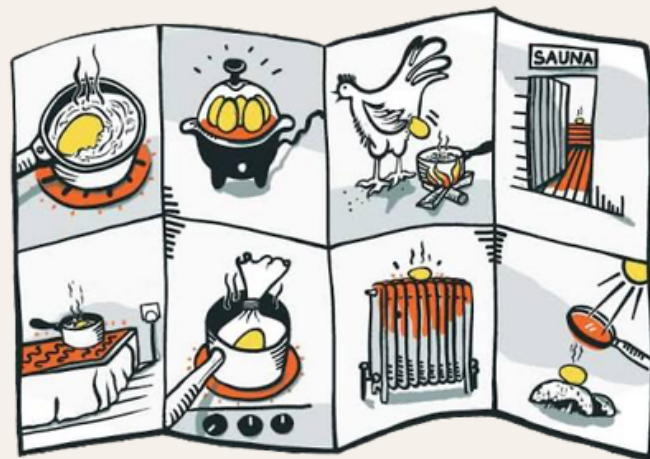
- Turns your research into a single, focused sentence
- Agreement on what you're actually solving
- Sets the direction for Develop





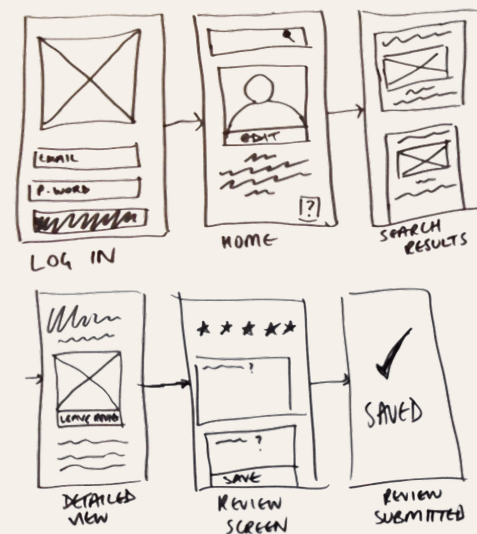
IDEATION

- **Crazy 8s:** Rapid brainstorming, 8 mins for 8 ideas
- **SCAMPER:** Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate, or Reverse an existing product or service.



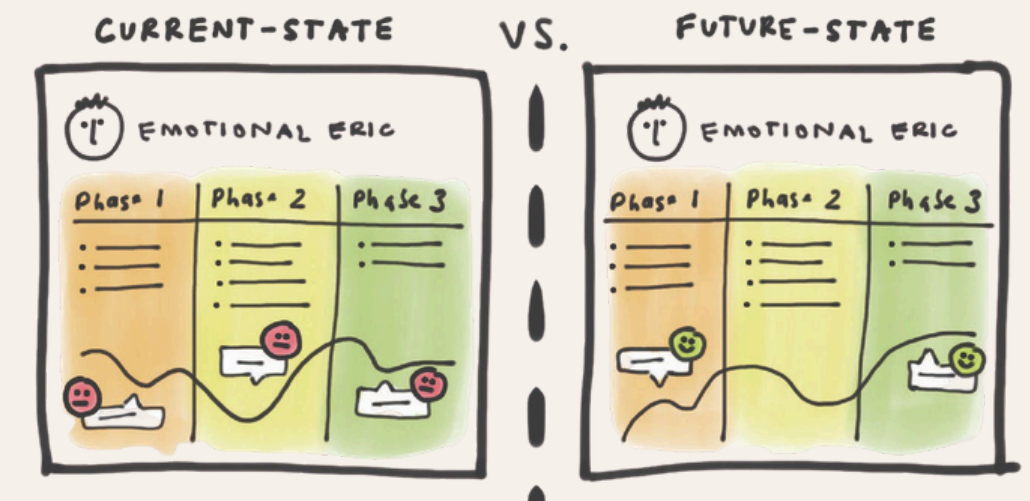
LOW FIDELITY PROTOTYPING

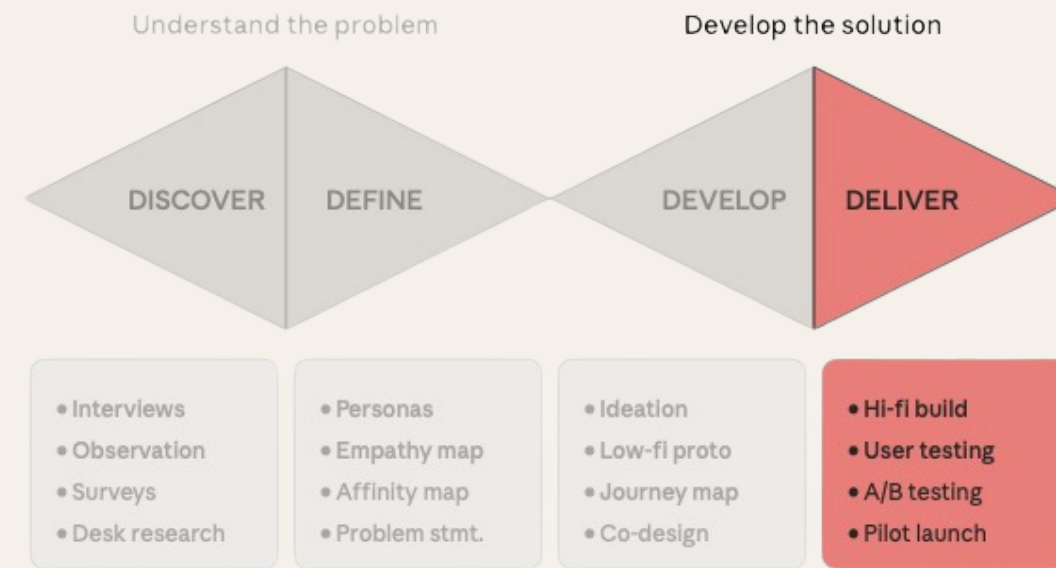
- **Wireframes***
- **Concept poster**
- **Paper prototypes**



JOURNEY MAPPING

- **As-is journey** developed in the Discover phase – now to the To-be journey





HIGH FIDELITY PROTOTYPING

- **Must do! User acceptance testing**
- **Accessibility check**

Theory of Change

If we do X, then Y happens, because Z

Design tool vs Diagnostic tool

Different uses before and after you build

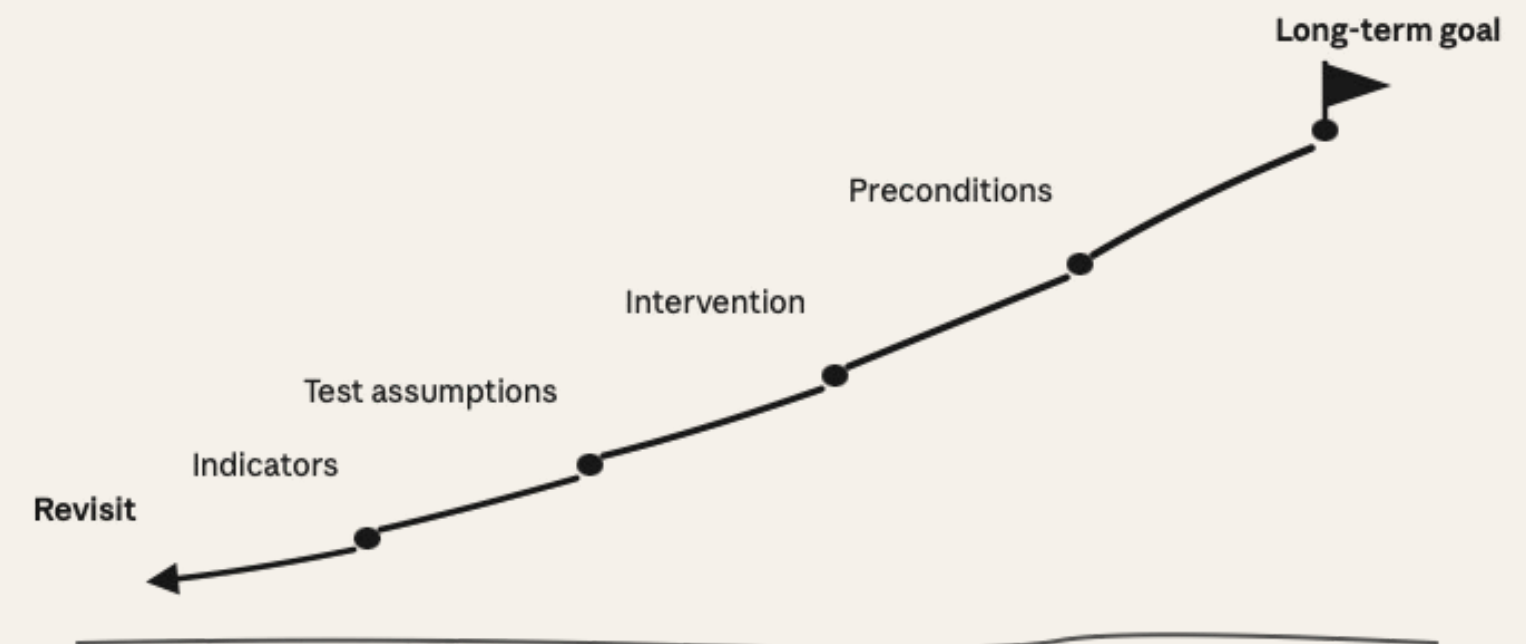


Case Study: Visilant and AI-enabled eye care for remote communities

Theory of Change

If we do X, then Y happens, because Z

- **Identify the long-term goal**
- **Work backwards from it, not forwards from your idea**
- **Map the pathway of preconditions**
- **Only then, choose your intervention**
- **Surface and test your assumptions at each step**
- **Identify indicators, how you'll know each step happened**
- **Keep revisiting it as you learn**



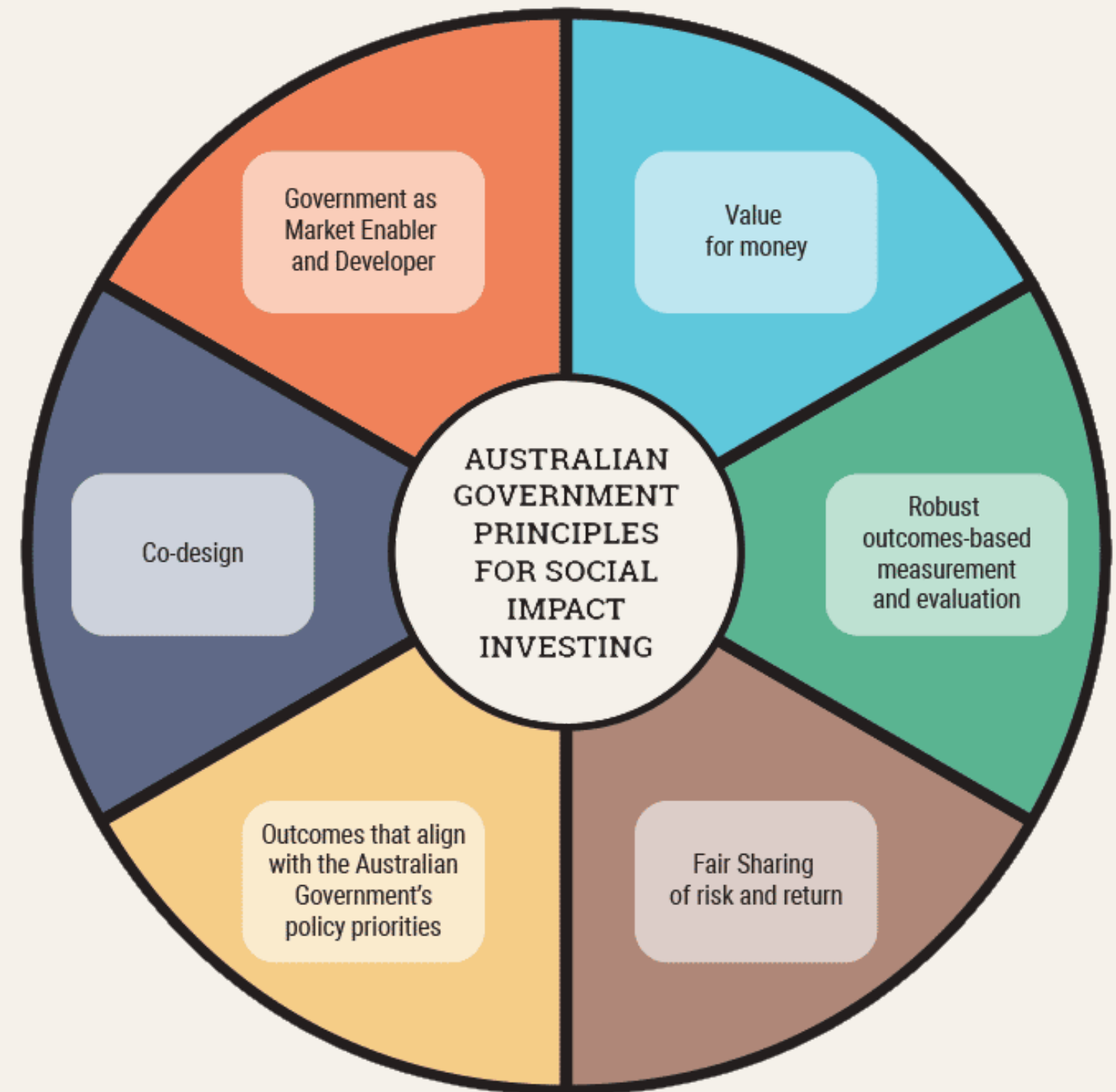
Some tips from a Project Manager

- **Diversity of perspective matters**
- **Get clear on roles and responsibilities**
- **Make a rough plan before you start**
- **Create a budget and revisit regularly**
- **Communicate**
- **Iterate**
- **Test with users before you get too far down the path**



Pitching and partnering

- The pitch is rarely one moment, usually a process
- Different conversations need different materials
- Tailor to your audience or partner, every time
- Tell the story
- Developing your pitch
 - New and novel
 - Desirable/feasible/viable
 - Testable before public launch
 - Backed by audience data, not assumption



Finding social impact challenges

- **Social impact ≠ commercial products**
- **Where to look: the UN SDGs, your own proximity, friction you've noticed, systems that no longer fit who uses them**
- **Human Rights (or Child Rights with the three Ps)**
- **Some problems are "wicked", and worth tackling anyway**



Resources

Stanford d.school
dschool.stanford.edu

IDEO Design Thinking resources
ideou.com/pages/design-thinking-resources

Digital Service Toolkit from NSW Gov
digital.nsw.gov.au/delivery/digital-service-toolkit

Theory of Change
theoryofchange.org



Book a mentoring time